In that match, Saeed Anwar and Saleem Elahi opened with the bat. They had a good start. Elahi got out when the scorecard read 60. I went in at number three.

There is an interesting Indian connection to my innings in that match. Sachin Tendulkar had given his favourite bat to Waqar Younis and asked for a favour. Sachin wanted Waqar to take the bat to Sialkot, Pakistan's world-famous sports-good manufacturing capital, and get a custom-made one replicated there. Wiqi bhai was thus the custodian of Sachin's great, favourite blade. But guess what Waqar did before he took it to Sialkot? He gave it to me, before I went in to bat. So effectively, that first century in Nairobi by Shahid Afridi was made with Sachin Tendulkar's best bat. Go figure.

People say that what happened in the match itself was remarkable and historic, but for me, it really wasn't. I remember the sequence but only mechanically. I padded up. I went in. I stopped the first ball. Then I hit the second ball for a six. After that, I don't remember much about what unfolded. Whatever came my way, I played it on its merit. If a ball was worth hitting, it got the required treatment.

It didn't bother me that Saeed Anwar was at the other end. Saeed is a legend and my favourite fellow batsman from that time, a stylish leftie whose strokeplay I keenly watched when the matches aired on TV. But his presence at the non-striker's end didn't unsettle me. Nor do I have anything significant to say about the fact that my innings was a landmark moment in cricket history. I didn't feel the gravity of the moment while batting. Facing the great Muttiah Muralitharan, Sanath Jayasuriya and Chaminda Vaas – all champions from Sri Lanka's 1996 World Cup-winning team – felt normal, too. It felt like a first-class or a club-cricket regulation game for me. Maybe I wasn't mature enough to understand what was going on. In that ground, at that moment, I felt like this was what I had always done and this was what I would always do.

Some say that my century in Nairobi that day, 4 October 1996, changed the way the modern game would be played. I won't pretend I did something remarkable – it didn't seem that way to me. I don't think I changed anything, nor did I perform in any special way or with any strategic plan in that innings. For me, my rhythm, my style – it was all my normal, regular approach towards batting. Maybe that's why I don't remember much of that innings. It was all standard hitting. Karachi had just met Nairobi, and while the latter was shocked, the former was just fine. Of course, Karachi wanted to prove a point.

But a couple of moments in that innings do stick out. Murali was in his prime at the time and known for being a crafty, sudden turner of the ball. So hitting him for a six – and I think I hit him for three or four sixes – was especially satisfying. My timing was better than it had ever been in those shots off Murali. In Pashto, we have a saying about hunting: the bigger the prey, the tastier the meal. I was taking the saying very seriously.

While at the crease, I didn't know I was setting a record. I only found out when I got back to the dressing room and Ramiz Raja told me, 'You've just set up a world record, partner.' I didn't take it that seriously. Numbers don't make sense to me – they never did and never will. Unlike a lot of cricketers, keeping up with statistics and records, generally or even my own, has never been my thing. I did ask, though, what the record was, just to be sure, and Ramiz said that it was for the fastest century ever, and I was also the youngest player to do so.

I still don't make much of it. In Nairobi, at the time, there was not a lot of local news coverage to read or watch. That probably helped me stay in my bubble. Later, after the match, I hung out